CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 15: **That Little Square Box** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The author makes the secrecy of the race believable by mentioning: 1

(a) captains' prejudice against such sports aboard ships
(b) the cost of tickets
(c) the weather
(d) the size of the cabin

2. A reader says: 'The story mocks fear.' A fair reply is that it: 1

(a) gently laughs at needless panic **(b)** praises the narrator's courage
(c) ridicules sailors **(d)** attacks the captain

3. Which is the strongest reason the story is suspenseful? 1

(a) the sea voyage **(b)** the ship's size
(c) the men's clothes **(d)** the clock deadline of ten o'clock

4. Which is NOT a clue the narrator misreads? 1

(a) the time of ten o'clock **(b)** the ship's name
(c) the clicking **(d)** the whitish grains

5. Which word best describes the tone of the ending? 1

(a) grave **(b)** mournful **(c)** light-hearted **(d)** bitter

6. What does the narrator's decision to hide in the lifeboat reveal? 1

(a) he cares for his own safety while still unwilling to speak
(b) he is playing a joke
(c) he trusts the men
(d) he is brave

7. If the story were told by Flannigan, which would change most? 1

(a) the sea **(b)** the mystery would vanish
(c) the ship's name **(d)** the pigeon's speed

8. If the box had really held a bomb, which character trait of the narrator would have been valuable? 1

(a) shyness **(b)** laziness **(c)** alertness **(d)** vanity

9. Why is the twist funny rather than sad? 1

(a) the ship sinks
(b) no one is hurt and the fear was unfounded
(c) the narrator is arrested
(d) someone dies

10. Choose the correct reported version: The narrator said, 'I shall tell the captain.' 1

(a) The narrator says he will tell the captain.
(b) The narrator said he shall tell the captain.
(c) The narrator said that he would tell the captain.
(d) The narrator said that I shall tell the captain.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Suggest what the narrator should have done and why. 2

12. Use 'suspicious' in a sentence relating to the story. 2

13. What is dramatic about the phrase describing the box as a 'pistol case'? 2

14. What does the story say about the effect of imagination on fear? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. How does the narrator's dilemma reflect real-life choices? 3

16. Evaluate the narrator's decision to hide rather than act. 3

17. Discuss the narrator's emotions from start to finish. 3

OR

Is the narrator a hero or a comic figure? Argue. 3

18. Convert into a complex sentence: 'He heard the clicking. He feared a bomb.' 3

OR

Why do the men's actions seem natural once the truth is known? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Write a diary entry of the narrator after the incident. 5

OR

Evaluate how the first-person narration shapes the story's humour. 5

20. Write a story ending (about 100 words) in which the narrator apologises to the men and learns about the race. 5

OR

Write a dialogue between Flannigan and his friend about the day's events. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks